

Summer Reading 2026

Incoming 11th Grade

Read with a purpose. Consider how the protagonist's journey — or the author's argument — illuminates broader societal questions, and what the challenges faced, moral dilemmas encountered, and transformative moments reveal.

FICTION

American Dirt

Jeanine Cummins

Realistic Fiction, Immigration, Mexico

Armada

Ernest Cline

Science Fiction, Gaming

Bone Gap

Laura Ruby

Fantasy, Mystery

Camino Winds

John Grisham

Mystery, Thriller

Every Last Word

Tamara Ireland Stone

Realistic Fiction, Mental Health, Romance

Felix Ever After

Kacen Callender

Realistic Fiction, LGBTQ, Coming of Age

For the Win

Cory Doctorow

Science Fiction, Gaming, Labor

The Gentleman's Guide to Vice and Virtue

Mackenzi Lee

Historical Fiction, Adventure, LGBTQ

Hungry Hearts

Elsie Chapman & Caroline Tung Richmond (eds.)

Short Stories, Food, Immigration

It Ends with Us

Colleen Hoover

Contemporary Fiction, Domestic Abuse

Life on Mars

Jonathan Strahan (ed.)

Short Stories, Science Fiction

Love, Hate and Other Filters

Samira Ahmed

Realistic Fiction, Identity, Islam

Orphan Train

Christina Baker Kline

Historical Fiction, Dual Timeline

Six of Crows

Leigh Bardugo

Fantasy, Adventure

American Street

Ibi Zoboi

Realistic Fiction, Immigration, Haiti

Bodega Dreams

Ernesto Quiñonez

Realistic Fiction, Coming of Age, Urban

The Boyfriend Wish

Swati Teerdhala

Romance, Contemporary

Challenger Deep

Neal Shusterman

Realistic Fiction, Mental Health

Far from the Tree

Robin Benway

Realistic Fiction, Adoption, Family

Forgive Me, Leonard Peacock

Matthew Quick

Realistic Fiction, Mental Health

Frankly in Love

David Yoon

Realistic Fiction, Romance, Korean American

The Henna Artist

Alka Joshi

Historical Fiction, India

I Am Not Your Perfect Mexican Daughter

Erika L. Sánchez

Realistic Fiction, Grief, Latinx

Legendborn

Tracy Deonn

Fantasy, Arthurian

A Long Petal of the Sea

Isabel Allende

Historical Fiction, Spain, Chile

The Nightingale

Kristin Hannah

Historical Fiction, WWII, France

Project Hail Mary

Andy Weir

Science Fiction, Adventure

Something in Between

Melissa De la Cruz

Realistic Fiction, Immigration

Starfish

Akemi Dawn Bowman

Realistic Fiction, Mental Health

The Upside of Unrequited

Becky Albertalli

Realistic Fiction, LGBTQ+

The Way I Used to Be

Amber Smith

Realistic Fiction, Trauma

Whale Talk

Chris Crutcher

Realistic Fiction, Sports

Zeroboxer

Fonda Lee

Science Fiction, Sports

Take the Mic

Jason Reynolds (ed.)

Short Stories, Social Justice

The Voting Booth

Brandy Colbert

Realistic Fiction, Romance

This Is My America

Kim Johnson

Realistic Fiction, Social Justice

When Dimple Met Rishi

Sandhya Menon

Realistic Fiction, Romance

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NONFICTION

The 57 Bus

Dashka Slater

Narrative Nonfiction, Hate Crime, Justice

Beast

Doug Merlino

Narrative Nonfiction, Sports, MMA

Boost!

Michael Bar-Eli

Nonfiction, Sports Psychology, Business

Can't Hurt Me

David Goggins

Memoir, Self-Motivation, Military

A Crack in Creation

Jennifer Doudna & Samuel Sternberg

Science, Genetics, Ethics

Endurance

Scott Kelly

Memoir, Space, Science

Kent State

Derf Backderf

Graphic Nonfiction, History, War

Ordinary Hazards

Nikki Grimes

Memoir, Poetry, Resilience

The Radium Girls

Kate Moore

Narrative Nonfiction, History, Labor

Rich AF

Vivian Tu

Nonfiction, Personal Finance

Rocket Boys

Homer H. Hickam

Memoir, Space, Coming of Age

Singled Out

Andrew Maraniss

Biography, Baseball, LGBTQ

The Spider Network

David Enrich

Narrative Nonfiction, Finance, Corruption

Unpunished Murder

Lawrence Goldstone

History, Civil Rights, Law

Atomic Habits

James Clear

Self-Help, Psychology

Becoming

Michelle Obama

Memoir, Politics, Race

Bravey

Alexi Pappas

Memoir, Track, Film

Cinderella Ate My Daughter

Peggy Orenstein

Nonfiction, Gender, Culture

Crossing the Line

Kareem Rosser

Memoir, Sports, Coming of Age

Girl Code

Andrea Gonzales & Sophie Houser

Nonfiction, Technology, Women

My Greatest Save

Briana Scurry

Memoir, Soccer, LGBTQ

Poisoned Water

Candy J. Cooper & Marc Aronson

Narrative Nonfiction, Environment, Race

Return of the King

Brian Windhorst & Dave McMenamin

Narrative Nonfiction, Basketball, Sports

Rise

Daniel Rodriguez

Memoir, Military, Sports

Running to Glory

Sam McManis

Narrative Nonfiction, Sports, Immigration

Solito: A Memoir

Javier Zamora

Memoir, Immigration, El Salvador

Stamped from the Beginning

Ibram X. Kendi

History, Race, Civil Rights

Vets and Pets

Dava Guerin & Kevin Ferris

Nonfiction, Veterans, Animals

Wasted

Marya Hornbacher

Memoir, Eating Disorders, Mental Health

Fans

Larry Olmsted

Nonfiction, Sports

Ways of Grace

James Blake & Carol Taylor

Memoir, Tennis, Social Justice